personality that could draw admiration and respect, he lacked that emotional appeal which alone can keep a party together through fair weather and foul.

In the domain of Hindu-Moslem relations, too, the Deshabandhu was a unifying force. His 'Bengal Pact' which had been rejected by the Coconada Congress in December 1923, but had been ratified by the Provincial Conference in May 1924, had served to convince all Moslems that he was their real friend. That such a man was at the head of the Swaraj Party helped to rally Moslem support for that Party and as a matter of fact, the Swaraj Party in the Bengal Legislative Council had a large number of Moslem members who had been elected on a basis of separate electorate. With the death of the Deshabandhu, the Moslem community no longer retained their former confidence in the Swaraj Party. Moreover, the political tension created by the Swaraj Party which had served to hold back the rising tide of communalism, subsided after his death and the country was then plunged in intercommunal strife which usurped the field for about two years. There was another unfortunate development following the death of the Deshabandhu—namely the weakening of the extremist attitude of the Party. When the Swaraj Party first came into existence, it had drawn elements both from the Right and from the Left. During the lifetime of the leader the Left elements had the upper hand because he himself belonged to the Left. But in his absence the Right elements were able to raise their head. The emergency of intercommunal strife also helped to bring to the fore people who generally fought shy of politics and who were averse to doing anything which involved suffering and sacrifice. In Bengal the Left Wing was at a disadvantage for some time, because a large number of Congressmen belonging to that group were in prison either under Regulation III of 1818 or under the Bengal Ordinance.

From the middle of 1925 onwards there was a gradual watering down of the original Swarajist Policy of undiluted opposition. In June, Pandit Motilal Nehru accepted a seat on the Skeen Committee appointed by the Government to report on the Indianisation of the Army. Not long after this, Mr. S. B. Tambe,[1] a prominent member of the Swaraj Party of the Central Provinces,

[1] Mr. Tambe later on became the Acting Governor of the Central Provinces when the Governor went home on leave for some months.